

How iBSIPT compares to iBSIECB

Methodological Correspondence Guide

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The structure and coverage of iBSIPT differ from those of the ECB's iBSI dataset and are therefore not directly comparable. Nevertheless, a correspondence between the two datasets can be established. This non-official guide describes the main methodological and reporting differences between iBSIPT and the ECB's iBSI dataset, and provides practical guidance to support the reconciliation and comparison of their data.

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Executive Summary

Although iBSIPT and the ECB iBSI dataset are derived from the same regulatory reporting framework, they are not directly comparable. Differences arise from dataset coverage, classification methodologies, aggregation rules, and reporting conventions. Researchers comparing the two sources should pay particular attention to:

- Coverage of reporting monetary financial institutions (MFIs);
- Counterparty region classifications;
- Counterparty sector reporting;
- Deposit classifications;
- Availability of maturity breakdowns.

This guide provides an overview of the principal methodological differences and practical guidance for reconciling information across the two datasets.

Introduction

Both iBSIPT and the ECB's iBSI dataset are governed by the same regulatory framework, namely Regulation (EU) No 2021/379 and, previously, Regulation (EU) No 1071/2013. As a result, the underlying reporting requirements are largely consistent across both datasets.

However, differences emerge in the organization, aggregation, and dissemination of the data. In several areas, iBSIPT provides a higher level of granularity than the ECB iBSI dataset because some information transmitted to the ECB is subject to additional aggregation requirements before dissemination.

Coverage also differs. Until November 2018, the ECB iBSI dataset included only a limited sample of Portuguese MFIs. From December 2018 onwards, reporting coverage expanded, although reporting derogations remained available for certain small institutions. In contrast, iBSIPT contains all entities that meet the ECB definition of an MFI throughout the reference period.

Additional differences reflect the distinct analytical objectives of the two datasets. For example, the ECB iBSI dataset classifies some deposits according to their inclusion in monetary aggregates (M3), whereas iBSIPT follows a traditional instrument-based classification. Methodological differences in counterparty classification also affect the treatment of non-resident exposures.

This document highlights the most relevant differences but should not be considered an exhaustive reference. Researchers working with ECB balance sheet aggregate statistics should carefully review the methodology underlying those statistics before drawing conclusions.

Number of reporting MFIs

Until November 2018, the ECB’s iBSI dataset covered only six Portuguese MFIs. Coverage subsequently expanded to more than 30 reporting institutions. By comparison, iBSIPT contains approximately 70 reporting entities. When comparing time series across datasets, users should carefully consider the impact of these differences in reporting coverage.

Counterparty region

iBSIPT classifies counterparties into three geographical regions: *domestic (1)*, *euro area excluding Portugal (2)*, and *rest of the world (3)*. In contrast, the ECB’s iBSI dataset uses five categories: *euro area (U2)*, *extra euro area (U4)*, *other euro-area Member States (U5)*, *domestic (U6)*, and *unspecified (Z5)*. When comparing the two classifications, the following methodological aspects should be considered:

- Some categories are directly comparable. For example, the iBSIPT category *euro-area, excluding Portugal (2)* corresponds to *other euro-area Member States (U5)* in the ECB’s iBSI dataset.
- Other categories do not have a direct equivalent. In particular, iBSIPT does not include an unspecified geographical category, whereas the ECB dataset includes category *unspecified (Z5)*.
- For some balance-sheet items, the ECB reports only the aggregate *euro area (U2)* category, without distinguishing between domestic and other euro-area counterparties (see L2C and L2D in the Balance Sheet items section for more details). iBSIPT, by contrast, always preserves this distinction.

Counterparty sector

The correspondence between counterparty sectors is generally straightforward because both datasets are based on the European System of Accounts (ESA) classification framework. However, iBSIPT typically provides a more detailed sectoral breakdown. Additionally, the following methodological aspects should be considered:

- In the ECB’s iBSI dataset, exposures reported under the counterparty region *extra euro area (U4)* are assigned to counterparty sector *unspecified (0000)*. By contrast, iBSIPT preserves the sector classification of counterparties located in the *rest of the world (3)*, allowing researchers to identify the institutional sector involved.

- The balance-sheet item *110 - Cash* is assigned to counterparty sector *1100 - Central Bank* in iBSIPT. In the ECB's iBSI dataset, the same item is reported under *0000 - Unspecified counterparty sector*.

Balance sheet items

Most balance-sheet items have a direct correspondence across the two datasets. The most significant differences concern loans and deposits.

- Loans to households are broken down by purpose into housing loans and consumer loans. In iBSIPT, these exposures are reported under *122 - Loans, house purchase* and *125 - Loans, consumption and other personal lending*, which correspond respectively to *A22* and *A25* in the ECB's iBSI dataset. For loans to other sectors, however, the correspondence is less direct. iBSIPT reports these exposures under *123 - Loans, other lending*, whereas the ECB's iBSI dataset groups them under the broader category *A20 - Loans*, without a separate item equivalent to *123*.
- The classification of deposits differs substantially between the two datasets, because the ECB applies a monetary aggregates framework (M3/non-M3), whereas iBSIPT applies a traditional instrument-based classification:
- In iBSIPT, all deposit liabilities are consistently broken down into *221 - Overnight deposits*, *222 - Deposits with agreed maturity*, *223 - Deposits redeemable at notice*, and *224 - Repurchase agreements*, and this classification applies for all counterparties sectors and regions.
- In ECB's iBSI dataset the reporting schemes depends on the counterparty sector and region:
 - Deposits held by non-euro-area residents (*U4 - Extra euro area*) are reported under the aggregate item *L20 - Deposit liabilities*, without a breakdown by deposit type.
 - Deposits from MFIs, central government, and non-MFI financial corporations resident in the euro area are classified according to their inclusion in monetary aggregates. Deposits with an original maturity of up to two years are reported as *L2C - Deposit liabilities included in M3*, while deposits with an original maturity exceeding two years are reported as *L2D - Deposit liabilities not included in M3*.
 - Deposits from households and non-financial corporations resident in the euro area are reported using the traditional breakdown into *L21 - Overnight deposits*, *L22 - Deposits with agreed maturity*, *L23 - Deposits redeemable at notice*, and *L24 - Repurchase agreements*, which is broadly comparable to the iBSIPT classification.

Maturity

The availability of maturity information varies according to the balance-sheet item, counterparty sector, and counterparty region. Consequently, the maturity matrices available in iBSIPT and the ECB iBSI dataset are not identical.

Researchers should therefore verify the availability and definition of maturity categories before attempting detailed comparisons.

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